

Soul Food Break*fast



Created By: Dr. D Brown

Foundation in Christ | Adult Edition

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES

Break · fast - Month 1

Adult Edition

Theme:

Part I: Prayer, the First Resort

“In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God. “-Phil 4:6 (WEB)

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This book is designed as a Bible study and devotional resource. It is not intended to replace professional counseling, pastoral covering, medical care, or legal/financial advice. Readers are encouraged to seek appropriate professional help when needed and to remain connected to a Bible-believing local church.

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DEDICATION

This work is dedicated first and foremost to the Lord Jesus Christ, the Living Word and true Bread of Life. May every page point back to Him.

To every hungry heart that has ever sat in a pew, at a kitchen table, on a lunch break, or in a quiet corner whispering, “Lord, I want to understand Your Word, but I don’t know where to start”—these lessons were written with you in mind. You are not invisible to God, and you are not too late for His promises.

To the intercessors, pastors, teachers, and destiny helpers who labor in prayer and service behind the scenes: your obedience, your “yes,” and your unseen sacrifices are the soil this work has grown from. May God reward you in ways no book could ever fully acknowledge.

And to every believer who has ever felt like “leftovers on the table of life,” may you discover through these pages that in God’s Kingdom you are never an afterthought. You are the guest of honor at a table He prepared just for you.

With love and gratitude,

Dr. Dametrice “Dee” Brown

Creator, SOFU Bible Study Series

QUICK START FOR LEADERS

Who this is for:

Pastors, ministers, small group leaders, Sunday school teachers, and facilitators using the Soul Food Series in any gathering (church, home, online, or community setting).

Session Length & Rhythm

- Recommended session time: 60–75 minutes
- Ideal pace: 1 lesson per week (or biweekly for deeper processing)
- Group size: 4–15 people works best.

Basic Flow for Each Lesson

1. Welcome & Prayer (5–10 min)
2. Appetizer (10–15 min)
3. Main Course: Bites + CST (30–35 min)
4. Dessert & To-Go Box (10–15 min)
5. Closing Prayer (5 min)

Tips for Leading Well

- Create a safe space; remind the group that what is shared stays in the group (w/ appropriate exceptions for safety).
- Honor time by starting and ending close to schedule.
- Let the Holy Spirit lead; the questions are a guide, not a cage.
- Model honesty and vulnerability.
- Invite participation, not performance.

Using Activities & Games

Use Trivia Mix-Up (Millionaire-style) and Tricky Testaments (Jeopardy-style) as openers to review the previous lesson or as closers to reinforce the current one. Let youth or emerging leaders help read questions, track scores, or lead a round to build ownership and confidence.

Before Each Session

- Read the Background Text and lesson in advance.
- (Optional) Play the audio companion track.
- Pray for wisdom, discernment, and sensitivity.
- Ask God who might need extra encouragement that day.

You don't have to be a Bible scholar to lead. You just must be willing, teachable, and available. God will take care of the rest.

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PROLOGUE

“Prayer for Divine Connection”

In the quiet of my heart, I seek Your face,
Elohim, Jesus Christ, fountain of grace.
Through ancient paths where prophets once trod,
I reach beyond the veil to touch my God.

Your Word, a lamp that guides through darkest night,
Transforms my weakness into holy might.
The Holy Spirit breathes where faith is born,
Three persons, one God—Father, Spirit, Son.

In perfect unity, the Trinity divine,
The Comforter within, Your presence mine.
The body of Christ, united as one,
Brother and sister beneath Your sun.

In family ties, both blood and spirit-bound,
Your kingdom's strength on earth is found.
When others stumble, empathy extends my hand,
With sympathy I weep, I pray, I stand.

The Spirit intercedes with groans too deep for words,
An advocate whose whisper's always heard.
For we are woven in Your love's design,
Each thread of mercy, wholly Thine.

Through sacrifice You broke sin's heavy chain,
Now in Your presence, I am born again.
The Spirit seals us, marked as heaven's own,
Until we stand before the eternal throne.

-S. L. Doctor



Introduction – *“Prayer, the First Resort”*

Before we can truly walk with God, we must first learn to talk with Him. Prayer is not simply a religious routine or a spiritual exercise—it is the first resort that ushers us into a genuine, living relationship with our Creator. From the very beginning, God desired fellowship with humanity, and prayer is the divine pathway through which that fellowship is restored and maintained.

When we pray, we are not informing God of what He does not know; rather, we are inviting Him into the center of our hearts, our situations, and our lives. Prayer is the language of dependence, the heart-beat of faith, and the foundation of intimacy with the Father. It is through prayer that our hearts are softened, our minds are renewed, and our will begins to align with His.

Jesus Himself modeled this truth. Before every major decision, miracle, and moment of ministry, He withdrew to pray (Luke 5:16). His life demonstrated that relationship with the Father was sustained through continual communion. If the Son of God was dedicated to prayer to remain connected, then how much more do we?

Prayer is not the result of a relationship—it is the beginning of it. It is the open door into knowing God personally, hearing His voice, and walking in His purpose. As we begin this study, let us approach prayer not as a duty but as an invitation—a sacred escort leading us deeper into the presence and love of God.

Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther

Second *IS* the Best

Theme: Prayer, the First Resort

Background Text: Esther 1–4 (focus on chapters 2–4)

Key Verse: Esther 4:14 (WEB)

“For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish. **Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?**”

Appetizer – Background (Esther 1–3) *summarized*

“The king loved Esther more than all the women, and she obtained favor and kindness in his sight more than all the virgins; so that he set the royal crown on her head, and made her queen instead of Vashti.” --Esther 2:17 (WEB)

Queen Vashti was breathtaking, bold, and unapologetically defiant — so when King Ahasuerus (Xerxes) summoned her to show off her beauty, she refused. Her refusal cost her the crown. A kingdom-wide search began for her replacement. Esther, a Jewish orphan raised by her cousin Mordecai, was chosen and crowned queen — not by luck, but divine placement.

Meanwhile, Haman was promoted, and the king commanded people to bow before him. Everyone complied except Mordecai. His refusal — rooted in the Ten Commandments — enraged Haman, who immediately plotted genocide.

CST Reflection:

Have you ever faced backlash for simply doing the right thing?

Main Course — The Call, the Crisis, and the Courage

Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Esther 4:13–14 (WEB)

“Then Mordecai asked them to return this answer to Esther: ‘Don’t think to yourself that you will escape in the king’s house any more than all the Jews. For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish. **Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?**’”

Esther learns that her crown cannot shield her from Haman’s decree. Mordecai positions her heart: This is bigger than beauty. Bigger than privilege. This is purpose.

CST Reflection:

When have you realized that your position was actually an assignment?

Bite 2 – The Fast that Shifted History, Esther 4:15–16 (WEB)

“Go, gather together all the Jews who are present in Susa, and **fast for me**, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day. I also and my maidens will fast in the same way. Then I will go in to the king, which is against the law; and if I perish, I perish.”

Esther requested a three-day fast — not a last resort, but a spiritual repositioning. Fasting clarifies. Fasting strengthens. Fasting shifts atmospheres. God was aligning Esther’s courage with divine timing.

Fasting Note: Always consult your pastor and doctor before engaging in fasting if you have health concerns.

CST Reflection:

What personal “fear barrier” do you need to fast through?

Bite 3 – The Turnaround, Esther 8:7 (WEB)

“I have given Esther the house of Haman... and they have hanged him... because he stretched out his hand against the Jews.”

The same gallows Haman built for Mordecai became the tool of his own undoing.

When Esther stepped into purpose, God shifted everything:

- A decree reversed
- A nation rescued
- The enemy exposed
- Honor restored

CST Reflection:

Where in your life can God turn evil intentions into divine promotion?

Dessert – God Works ALL Things Together, Romans 8:28 (WEB)

“We know that all things work together for good for those who love God, to those who are called according to his purpose.”

Esther didn’t come from royalty — she walked into it through obedience.

God used:

- her identity
- her humility
- her courage
- her fasting
- her placement

...to preserve an entire people. This is not a coincidence. This is covenant protection in action.

To-Go Box — Take This with You

God positions before He promotes.

Purpose requires courage.

Fasting unlocks clarity.

And obedience activates destiny.

Write one sentence you're taking with you:

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for divine placement and divine purpose. Strengthen us like Esther to stand boldly, speak wisely, and obey quickly—even when fear rises. Teach us to fast, to listen, and to move when You call. And remind us that You are the God who turns every evil plot into a testimony of Your power. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Write a short prayer about one thing you want to start praying about:

Review Questions

Who was King Ahasuerus’ first wife?

Why were the Jews’ lives threatened?

How long were they called to a fast?

What did Esther risk by going before the king unsummoned?

Activity – Mix & Match

Match		Name/Phrase		Description
	1	Haman	A	Esther's Cousin
	2	Mordecai	B	Wanted to destroy Jews
	3	Vashti	C	Death for coming without summons
	4	Why Fast was called	D	Refused to come when summoned
	5	How Haman died	E	By hanging at the Gallows

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Word Study

“King Ahasuerus” = Xerxes in some translations.

“Shushan” = Susa.

Practical counsel on fasting (consult pastor/doctor as applicable).

Notes & Group Discussion

BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon

The Question That Unlocked a Legacy

Theme: Prayer, the First Resort

Background Text: 1 Kings 3:5–14; 2 Chronicles 1:7–12; 1 Kings 4:29–30

Key Verse: 1 Kings 3:9 (WEB)

“Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this your great people?”

Appetizer — 1 Kings 3:5–7 (WEB)

⁵ In Gibeon Yahweh appeared to Solomon in a dream by night; and God said, “Ask for what you want me to give you.” ⁶ Solomon said, “You have shown to your servant David my father great loving kindness, according as he walked before you in truth, righteousness, and uprightness of heart with you. You have kept for him this great loving kindness, that you have given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is today.

⁷ Now, Yahweh my God, you have made your servant king instead of David my father. I am just a little child. I don’t know how to go out or come in.

When God met Solomon in Gibeon, He didn’t start with a demand—He started with an invitation. Solomon could have asked for power, revenge, or riches. Instead, his first instinct was to talk with God about how to lead well. Before crowns and kingdoms, God tested the posture of his heart.

CST Reflection

Before greatness begins, God often tests the posture of the heart. When God hands us a “blank check” moment, what we ask for reveals what we truly value—comfort, control, or kingdom wisdom.

Reflection Question

When God gives you a blank check of opportunity, what would your prayer reveal about your heart’s priorities?

Main Course

Bite 1 — God Is Pleased With the Request, 1 Kings 3:10–11 (WEB)

¹⁰ This request pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing. ¹¹ God said to him, “Because you have asked this thing, and have not asked for yourself long life, nor have asked riches for yourself, nor have asked the life of your enemies, but have asked for yourself understanding to discern justice,

Solomon could have used prayer as a way to secure more comfort for himself. Instead, he asked for an understanding heart to serve God’s people well. God was pleased, not because the words sounded spiritual, but because the request was selfless and aligned with His purposes.

CST

True prayer doesn’t manipulate—it aligns. Solomon’s request pleased God because it flowed from a heart that valued wisdom to serve over wealth to be seen.

Reflect:

How might your prayer life change if you sought God’s heart before His hand?

Bite 2 — Wisdom Before Wealth, 2 Chronicles 1:11–12 (WEB)

¹¹ God said to Solomon, “Because this was in your heart, and you have not asked riches, wealth, honor, or the life of those who hate you, nor yet have you asked for long life; but have asked for wisdom and knowledge for yourself, that you may judge my people, over whom I have made you king, ¹²therefore wisdom and knowledge is granted to you. I will give you riches, wealth, and honor, such as none of the kings have had who have been before you, and none after you will have.”

God granted Solomon what he asked for—wisdom and understanding—and then added what he didn’t ask for: riches, wealth, and honor. When wisdom comes first, blessings can follow without becoming idols. God can trust us with more when our heart is set on serving His people instead of promoting ourselves.

CST Reflection

God rewards those who seek understanding before abundance. When you desire wisdom more than you desire status, you make room for God to add what you never thought to ask for.

Reflect:

Where in your life do you feel pressure to chase “riches and honor” instead of asking first for wisdom to serve well?

Bite 3 — A Legacy That Starts in Prayer, 1 Kings 4:29–30 (WEB)

“God gave Solomon wisdom and understanding exceeding much, and very great understanding, even as the sand that is on the seashore. Solomon’s wisdom excelled the wisdom of all the children of the east, and all the wisdom of Egypt.”

Solomon’s wisdom became his reputation. People knew him not just for what he had, but for the way he thought, judged, and led. What began as a private conversation with God in a dream turned into a public legacy that reached the nations. Solomon’s story shows that legacy doesn’t begin on a platform—it begins in God’s presence.

Reflection

How could your private time with God today shape how people remember your life tomorrow?

Dessert — The Legacy of a Wise Heart

God gave Solomon abundant wisdom and understanding “like the sand that is on the seashore,” and his wisdom exceeded that of all the surrounding nations.

The story of Solomon reminds us that real greatness starts with a listening heart. When we ask for wisdom instead of applause, God can use our lives to bless people we may never meet.

CST Reflection

Write one sentence about the kind of spiritual legacy you want to leave.

To-Go Box

- The strength of your leadership flows from the sincerity of your prayers.
- God is pleased when you ask for wisdom to serve others well.
- Solomon’s legacy began not with a throne, but with a conversation with God.

Carry this truth into your week:

Ask God for wisdom first—then trust Him with everything else.

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for the example of Solomon’s request. Teach me to value wisdom over wealth and understanding over image. Align my heart with Your priorities so that my prayers please You. Give me an understanding heart to serve well wherever You have placed me. Let my life reflect Your wisdom and bring You honor. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Personal Prayer Space

Activity – “Wisdom First” (Fill-in-the-Blank)

Complete the statements based on today’s lesson:

1. Solomon asked God for _____ and _____ to govern His people.
2. God was pleased because Solomon did *not* ask for _____, _____, or the _____ of his enemies.
3. Solomon’s legacy teaches us that _____ comes before _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Note Section— Group Discussion & Personal Study

Use this space to jot down insights, testimonies, or key points from group discussion:

BM1 — Lesson 3: Jesus

Prayer the First Resort

Theme: Prayer, the First Resort

Background Text: Luke 5:15–16; Luke 11:1–4; Luke 18:1–8; John 17

Key Verse: Luke 18:1 (WEB)

“He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up;”

Appetizer — WWJD: What Would Jesus Do? Luke 5:15–16 (WEB)

¹⁵ But the report concerning him spread much more, and great multitudes came together to hear, and to be healed by him of their infirmities. ¹⁶ But he withdrew himself into the desert, and prayed.”

CST Reflection

Crowds kept coming. Needs kept growing. Pressure kept rising. And Jesus did something that still challenges us: **He withdrew to pray.** He didn’t wait until everything broke. He didn’t treat prayer like a backup plan. If we’re asking *WWJD*—here’s a clear answer: **He would pray first, especially when life got louder.**

Reflection Question

When your life gets busier or more stressful, what usually gets cut first—rest, fun, prayer, or something else?

Main Course – The Mediator and the Model

Bite 1 — “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4 (WEB)

¹ When he finished praying in a certain place, one of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray, just as John also taught his disciples.”

² He said to them, “When you pray, say,
‘Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy.
May your Kingdom come.

May your will be done on earth, as it is in heaven.

³ Give us day by day our daily bread.

⁴ Forgive us our sins, for we ourselves also forgive everyone who is indebted to us. Bring us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.’ ”

CST Thought

The disciples didn’t ask Jesus to teach them crowds, platforms, or popularity—they asked about prayer. They watched His life and realized **prayer was the engine**. Jesus gave them a pattern: start with God’s holiness and Kingdom, trust Him for daily needs, walk in forgiveness, and ask for strength in temptation.

Reflection Question

Which part of that pattern do you rely on most—worship, daily needs, forgiveness, or spiritual strength? Which part do you skip?

Bite 2 — Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5 (WEB)

¹ He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up, ² saying, “There was a judge in a certain city who didn’t fear God, and didn’t respect man. ³ A widow was in that city, and she often came to him, saying, ‘Defend me from my adversary!’

⁴ He wouldn’t for a while; but afterward he said to himself, ‘Though I neither fear God, nor respect man, ⁵ yet because this widow bothers me, I will defend her, or else she will wear me out by her continual coming.’

CST Thought

Jesus tells a story about persistence because He knows how life works. Delay can make you tired. Silence can make you doubt. But Jesus is clear: **don’t give up**. If a person can keep showing up for justice, how much more should we keep showing up to God in faith?

Reflection Question

Is there something you used to pray about that you stopped praying for because it took too long?

Bite 3 — God Is Not Like the Unjust Judge Luke 18:6–8 (WEB)

⁶ The Lord said, “Listen to what the unrighteous judge says. ⁷ Won’t God avenge his chosen ones, who are crying out to him day and night, and yet he exercises patience with them? ⁸ I tell you that he will avenge them quickly. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?”

CST Thought

God keeps His promises—always. Even in seasons of delay or confusion, His Word sustains us. Jeremiah 29 reminds us to seek God, pray for the welfare of the place we’re in, and trust His larger plan for our lives.

Author’s Testimony – A Lesson in Trust

One morning, I began my day with prayer:

“Lord, please be in charge of today. Allow me to rely on Your peace. Take control of today.”

Before 8 a.m., everything seemed to go sideways. A tenant’s water was shut off, and there were other moving pieces that could have easily sent me into stress mode. But instead of panicking, I felt an unexpected peace.

God quietly reminded me, “Just call the local store.”

I did. They gave me the name of a retired plumber. He came out, fixed the issue, and the cost was exactly the \$40 I had withdrawn the night before—without knowing why I would need it. That’s God’s foresight and favor.

Reflection Question

1. What situation did you trust Jesus to handle, and what was the result?
-

Dessert — Prayer that Unites, John 17:20–21 (WEB)

“Not for these only do I pray, but for those also who believe in me through their word, that they may all be one, even as you, Father, are in me, and I in you, that they also may be one in us; that the world may believe that you sent me.”

CST Thought

Even before the cross, Jesus prayed for us. He sought the Father for strength, direction, and surrender. That’s the model: **prayer in the beginning, prayer in the middle, prayer at the finish.**

To-Go Box

- This life is not over until your last breath.
- Keep praying. Keep trusting. Keep resting in the One who intercedes for you.
- “Pray without ceasing.” (1 Thessalonians 5:17, WEB)

Carry this truth into every season: Jesus still meets you first in prayer.

Group Prayer – Following Jesus’ Example

Remember Jesus’ prayer in Gethsemane and His High Priestly prayer in John 17. Pray for unity, peace, and strength.

“Lord, help us to surrender our will to Yours.

Teach us to rest in Your promises,
and fill us with the same glory and unity

You shared with the Father.

Make us one in heart and purpose.

In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Notes Section— Group Discussion & Personal Study

BM1 — Lesson 4: Paul & Silas

Faith in the Dark

Theme: Prayer, The First Resort/Praise in Midnight Moments

Background Text: Acts 16:16–34; Isaiah 26:3; Philippians 4:6–7

Key Verse : Acts 16:25–26 (WEB)

“But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them. Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone’s bonds were loosened.”

Appetizer – Praise in the Darkest Hour, Acts 16:25; Isaiah 26:3 (WEB)

“But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them.”

“You will keep whoever’s mind is steadfast in perfect peace, because he trusts in you.”

It was the darkest hour—a time that should have been filled with despair. Instead, it became a moment of praise and rejoicing. Paul and Silas were in chains, yet their mouths were full of worship. Their situation said “panic,” but their spirit chose “praise.”

CST Thought

God promises perfect peace to those who fix their minds on Him. His peace is not the absence of trouble, but a deep, enduring confidence in His unchanging nature. In the midnight of life’s trials, when everything feels shut in and locked down, praise can turn despair into deliverance.

Reflection Question

When has God given you peace when everything around you said panic?

Main Course – Power in the Praises

Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24, 31 (WEB)

²²The multitude rose up together against them, and the magistrates tore their clothes off of them, and commanded them to be beaten with rods. ²³When they had laid many stripes on them, they threw them into prison, charging the jailer to keep them safely, ²⁴who, having received such a charge, threw them into the inner prison, and secured their feet in the stocks.”

³¹ They said, ‘Believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved, you and your household.’

CST Commentary

Paul and Silas were not in prison for committing a crime—they were there for preaching salvation through Jesus Christ: *“Believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved.”* They were beaten, humiliated, and locked up for doing what was right—yet they didn’t lose faith. Your weakest, worst moment can become your greatest testament to the power of God. (Remember Jesus in the Garden of Gethsemane.)

Reflection Question

What would your praise sound like if it echoed in the middle of your pain?

Bite 2 – Peace That Passes Understanding, Acts 16:25–26 (WEB)

25 But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prison-ers were listening to them. 26 Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone’s bonds were loosened.”

CST Commentary

It’s amazing what can happen when you keep your mind stayed on Him (see Isaiah 26:3). Their voices turned a prison into a sanctuary, and their pain became a praise report. Sometimes your midnight melody becomes someone else’s breakthrough song. Certain songs, like *“Holy Forever”* by CeCe Winans, strengthen my heart when life feels heavy because they lift my focus off the problem and onto His power.

Reflection Question

What worship song or prayer brings you back to peace when life feels heavy?

Bite 3 – Contagious Praise, Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:27–30 (WEB)

²⁷ The jailer, being roused out of sleep and seeing the prison doors open, drew his sword and was about to kill himself, supposing that the prisoners had escaped. ²⁸ But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, ‘Don’t harm yourself, for we are all here!’ ²⁹ He called for lights and sprang in, and, fell down trembling before Paul and Silas, ³⁰ and brought them out and said, ‘Sirs, what must I do to be saved?’

CST Thought

Paul and Silas’s praise didn’t just free them—it freed everyone in earshot. That’s the power of contagious worship: when you lift up Jesus, the chains fall off everyone near you. Your faith can set an atmosphere that invites others into freedom.

Reflection Question

Who has been influenced by your praise or perseverance?

Dessert – Joy Unspeakable Joy, Acts 16:31–34 (WEB)

³¹ They said, ‘Believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved, you and your household.’ ³² They spoke the word of the Lord to him, and to all who were in his house. ³³ He took them the same hour of the night, and washed their stripes, and was immediately baptized, he and all his household. ³⁴ He brought them up into his house, and set food before them, and rejoiced greatly, with all his household, having believed in God.”

CST Commentary

Praise is contagious, and faith is transferable. Paul and Silas's obedience led to the warden's family's salvation. What began as a night of pain ended in joy—unspeakable joy.

To-Go Box

- When you choose praise over panic, God moves immediately.
- He can still shake foundations, open doors, and loose chains—not just yours, but everyone within reach of your faith.
- No matter what the problem, Jesus will always be the answer.

Carry this truth into every season:

Your midnight praise can become somebody else's morning miracle.

Prayer

“Lord Jesus, Thank You for being with us in our midnight moments. Teach us to choose praise over panic and to trust that You are working even when we cannot see it. Let our worship create an atmosphere where others can experience freedom, salvation, and joy. Use our pain as a platform for Your power. In Your name we pray, amen.”

Reflection & Group Discussion

1. When has God used a hard season in your life to encourage someone else?

2. What is one “midnight situation” you need to surrender to God in praise right now?

3. Who comes to mind when you think about someone who needs to “hear” your praise?

Group Reflection

Sometimes when the Spirit prompts you to shout or praise, it's not just for you. Someone within earshot might need that breakthrough. Glory be to God for every chain that falls when we praise.

Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study

Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 (AE) Answer Key

Theme: Prayer, the First Resort

Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best

Activity – Mix & Match

Match each name/phrase with the correct description:

Match		Name/Phrase		Description
B	1	Haman	A	Esther's Cousin
A	2	Mordecai	B	Wanted to destroy Jews
D	3	Vashti	C	Death for coming without summons
C	4	Why Fast was called	D	Refused to come when summoned
E	5	How Haman died	E	By hanging at the Gallows

Answer Key:

- 1 → b (Haman – plotter who wanted to destroy the Jews)
- 2 → a (Mordecai – cousin who refused to bow)
- 3 → d (Vashti – former queen removed)
- 4 → c (The Fast – three days before Esther went to the king)
- 5 → e (The Gallows – where Haman was executed)

Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Solomon asked God for _____ and _____ to govern His people.
2. God was pleased because Solomon did not ask for _____, _____, or the _____ of his enemies.
3. Solomon’s story shows that _____ comes before _____.

Answer Key:

1. wisdom and understanding
 2. long life, riches/wealth, or the death/lives of his enemies
 3. wisdom comes before wealth
-

Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort

Activity – “Prayer Map” (Gethsemane-style prayer)

This activity is reflective, not right-or-wrong:

- Students write a two-part prayer:
 - “Father, I feel...” (honesty)
 - “Nevertheless, Your will be done in...” (surrender)

Answer Key:

- Open-ended/journaling. No fixed correct answers.

Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark

Activity – “Midnight Playlist” (or your final title)

Students:

1. Write one worship song or phrase that helps them focus on God.
2. Complete: “When I feel _____, this reminds me that God is _____.”

Answer Key:

- Open-ended/journaling. No fixed correct answers.

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES

Break • fast - Month 2

Adult Edition

Theme:

The Art of Through

The Lord is my shepherd; I shall not want...

Psalm 23 (KJV)

Introduction – *The Art of Through*

“The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want.” — Psalm 23:1 (KJV)

Many times in life, we feel stuck. It might be at the starting line, or right in the messy middle. At times, it feels like our feet are chained to invisible blocks buried deep in the ground. No matter how much we want to move forward, something holds us in place.

This month’s lessons are designed to walk us through stories of people who faced real adversity—but didn’t give up. From Joseph in the pit, to Hannah in her barrenness, to Abram caught between promise and fulfillment, to those who pushed through crowds and pain for a touch from Jesus—each one shows us the **art of through**.

You don’t need to be a pro, a priest, or a “seasoned saint” to make it through hard seasons. You just need determination, honest faith, and a willingness to keep walking with God when giving up would be easier.

Everyone has a story. Many stories are similar, but your journey still feels uniquely your own. Psalm 23, written by David, reflects the heart of someone who knew rejection, doubt, and danger—yet kept following the Shepherd. Victory didn’t come by going *around* the valley, but by walking *through* it with God.

This segment of study explores biblical figures who endured trials and still pressed through. Their stories remind us that in God, we win not by skipping the struggle, but by trusting the Shepherd to lead us through to the other side.

Breakfast Edition Month 2: Lesson 1 – Joseph

The Young Dreamer

Theme: From pit to purpose

Background Text: Genesis 37; 39; 41–42

Key Verse: Genesis 42:6 (WEB)

“Joseph’s brothers came, and bowed themselves down to him with their faces to the earth.”

Appetizer – The Dream That Started It All, Genesis 37:5–8 (WEB)

“⁵Joseph dreamed a dream, and he told it to his brothers, and they hated him all the more. ⁶He said to them, ‘Please hear this dream which I have dreamed: ⁷for behold, we were binding sheaves in the field, and behold, my sheaf arose and also stood upright; and behold, your sheaves came around, and bowed down to my sheaf.’

⁸His brothers said to him, ‘Will you indeed reign over us? Or will you indeed have dominion over us?’ They hated him all the more for his dreams and for his words.”

Joseph saw a glimpse of his future long before anyone else believed it. What God showed him made his brothers jealous and angry, but their feeling didn’t invalidate the fact that dream still came from God.

CST – Called Before You’re Ready

God can give us glimpses of our destiny before others are ready to believe it—or before *we* fully understand it. Favor can feel lonely when the people closest to you don’t see what God has spoken over your life.

Reflection:

How do you stay humble when God’s favor on your life creates tension with others?

Main Course

Bite 1 — Betrayed but Chosen, Genesis 37:19–22, 28 (WEB, summarized)

¹⁸ They saw him afar off, and before he came near to them, they conspired against him to kill him. ¹⁹ They said to one another, ‘Behold, this dreamer comes. ²⁰ Come now therefore, and let’s kill him, and cast him into one of the pits...’

²⁸ Midianites who were merchants passed by, and they drew and lifted up Joseph out of the pit, and sold Joseph to the Ishmaelites for twenty pieces of silver. They brought Joseph into Egypt.

The very people who should have protected Joseph became the ones who betrayed him—but their evil could not cancel God’s plan.

CST – When Betrayal Becomes a Bridge

Sometimes betrayal doesn’t block your destiny—it *pushes* you toward it. The pit felt like punishment, but it was really a passageway. What others meant for harm, God was already folding into His larger story of rescue and preservation.

Reflection:

Think of a time when someone’s betrayal or rejection pushed you into a new chapter. How might God have been redirecting you?

Bite 2 — Integrity in the Dark, Genesis 39:7–8,10 (WEB)

⁷ After these things, his master’s wife set her eyes on Joseph; and she said, ‘Lie with me.’

⁸ But he refused, and said... ‘How then can I do this great wickedness, and sin against God?’

¹⁰ As she spoke to Joseph day by day, he didn’t listen to her...”

Joseph guarded his character even when no one from home was watching and when compromise might have seemed to make his life easier. His integrity and personal conviction mattered more in the moment than the temptation to be agreeable..

CST – Holiness When No One’s Looking

Holiness means running away from what others explain away. Joseph understood that sin isn’t just

breaking rules—it’s breaking God’s heart. He chose obedience over opportunity, even though it cost him his reputation and his freedom.

Reflection:

What guardrails (boundaries, habits, or people) help protect your integrity when temptation keeps coming “day after day”?

Bite 3 — From Prison to Palace, Genesis 41:14, 16, 38 (WEB)

¹⁴ Then Pharaoh sent and called Joseph, and they brought him hastily out of the dungeon...
¹⁶ Joseph answered Pharaoh, saying, ‘It isn’t in me. God will give Pharaoh an answer of peace.’
³⁸ Pharaoh said to his servants, ‘Can we find such a one as this, a man in whom is the Spirit of God?’”

In one day, Joseph went from prisoner to prime minister—but he made sure the glory went to God, not himself.

CST – Hidden Preparation, Sudden Promotion

God was preparing Joseph in places people forgot about: the pit and the prison. Those “wasted years” became his training ground in leadership, humility, and dependence on God. When the door finally opened, Joseph was ready—not because he was perfect, but because he stayed faithful.

Reflection:

Where do you feel “hidden” or overlooked right now? How might God be quietly preparing you for your next assignment?

Dessert — Faith Rewarded Genesis 42:5–6 (WEB, summarized)

Because of the famine, the sons of Israel came to buy grain in Egypt. Joseph, now governor over the land, was the one selling to everyone. His brothers arrived and bowed before him with their faces to the earth—just like the dream from his youth.

Reflection – When the Dream Matures

God’s dreams don’t die; they develop. The boy with the dream became the man with the responsibility to save many lives.

What promise from God have you carried for a long time that you’re starting to see unfold—or that you need to keep believing for?

To-Go Box

- The **pit**, the **prison**, and the **palace** were all part of Joseph’s training, not random pain.
- Betrayal couldn’t block God’s plan; it became the bridge God used to move Joseph into position.
- Integrity in hidden places prepared Joseph to carry influence in public places.
- God’s promotion often comes suddenly, but the preparation is usually slow and silent.
- What God speaks in a dream, He will fulfill in His time—our job is to stay faithful “through,” not just shout about the promise at the start.

Closing Prayer

“Lord God, thank You for the story of Joseph and for reminding us that You are working even when life feels unfair. Help us to trust You in the pit, to walk in integrity when no one is watching, and to stay faithful in seasons where we feel forgotten. Strengthen our faith to believe that Your promises will come to pass in Your perfect timing. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Reflection Questions

Where do you see yourself in Joseph’s journey right now—pit, prison, palace, or somewhere in between?

Write down one promise, dream, or calling from God that you refuse to give up on, even if it seems delayed.

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Joseph's brothers sold him for _____ pieces of silver.
2. Joseph resisted the temptation of _____.
3. Pharaoh said Joseph was filled with the _____ of God.
4. Joseph's brothers bowed before him in _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study

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BM2 — Lesson 2: Hannah

Barren but Not Lifeless

Theme: Prayer in the Pain

Background Text: 1 Samuel 1–2

Key Verse: 1 Samuel 1:27 (WEB)

“I prayed for this child, and Yahweh has given me my petition which I asked of him.”

Introduction

Elkanah was a Jewish man with two wives. In that culture, although love was part of why you married, having children was a major factor. Many times, barren women ended up divorced or pushed to the margins of society. Peninnah and Hannah were his wives, but Hannah could not have children.

Have you ever felt like you were “stuck” in someone else’s shadow? Like no matter what you did, the other person always seemed to be one step ahead? That was Hannah’s situation. Year after year, she was humiliated and reminded how much of a “failure” she was as a wife because she could not give Elkanah an heir.

At least her husband loved her, right? It didn’t feel that way. The voice of her tormentor cut deeply, and it seemed as if her prayers were bouncing off the ceiling.

Reflection(s)

Write down a memory of when you felt like the world kept you in its shadow. How have you dealt (or been dealing) with this situation?

Appetizer – The Weight of Waiting, 1 Samuel 1:7–8 (WEB)

“So year by year, when she went up to Yahweh’s house, her rival provoked her; therefore she wept, and didn’t eat. Elkanah her husband said to her, ‘Hannah, why do you weep? Why don’t you eat? Why is your heart grieved? Am I not better to you than ten sons?’”

In Jewish culture, having children is everything. If a man did not have a child, even if he was a scholar, he was not given the same honor. Their cultural and ethnic code weighed heavily on Hannah's mind. Her husband had every right, culturally, to divorce her and marry someone else. Inheritance and family legacy were tied to children.

In today's terms, Hannah showed signs of deep depression and grief. She felt that no one around her really understood or could comfort her. She stopped eating, cried endlessly, and felt useless.

If you or someone you know is going through something similar, there is help available. You do not have to battle alone—reach out to your church family, a community counselor, or a trusted friend.

CST: Desperation can drive determination.

How does persistent prayer reshape hopelessness into hope?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Provoked but Persistent, 1 Samuel 1:9–10 (WEB)

“So Hannah rose up after they had eaten in Shiloh, and after they had drunk. Now Eli the priest was sitting on his seat by the doorpost of Yahweh's temple. She was in bitterness of soul, and prayed to Yahweh, and wept bitterly.”

What do you do when you are really going through it? Who is the best person to turn to who can *truly* help? Many times, we go first to people who can listen—but cannot change anything. Hannah's womb was “lifeless,” but she took her lifelessness to the Living God.

CST: Pulse Check

Have you ever found yourself crying out to God from that dark place? Take a moment to write a prayer request—personal or for your family—that you want the Lord to work out.

Bite 2 – Prayer that Breaks Barrenness 1 Samuel 1:12–15 (WEB)

“As she continued praying before Yahweh, Eli observed her mouth. Now Hannah spoke in her heart; only her lips moved, but her voice was not heard. Therefore Eli thought she was drunk. Eli said to her, ‘How long will you be drunk? Get rid of your wine!’ Hannah answered, ‘No, my lord, I am a woman of a sorrowful spirit. I have drunk neither wine nor strong drink, but I poured out my soul before Yahweh.’”

A When you are at your lowest, even "religious" people might misjudge your struggle. But Hannah didn't let a man's mistake stop her from talking to her Maker. God hears the prayers that are too deep for words. God is our Promise Keeper, but sometimes *we* make promises to Him and then break them. If that has ever happened in your life, be honest with God.

Reflections:

Why is it important that we take these acts seriously? Can you think of examples of when people give or make vows (marriage, baptism, oaths, commitments)?

Bite 3 – Promise Fulfilled and Faith Honored, 1 Samuel 1:15–18 (WEB)

“Hannah answered, ‘No, my lord, I am a woman of a sorrowful spirit. I have drunk neither wine nor strong drink, but I poured out my soul before Yahweh. Don’t consider your servant a wicked woman; for I have been speaking out of the abundance of my complaint and my provocation.’ Then Eli answered, ‘Go in peace; and may the God of Israel grant your petition that you have asked of him.’ She said, ‘Let your servant find favor in your sight.’ So the woman went her way, and ate; and her facial expression wasn’t sad any more.”

It is OK to correct a false narrative. Allow your virtue and truth to shine even in dark situations. Eventually, God remembered Hannah. She conceived and gave birth to Samuel, and later brought him back to serve the Lord, just as she had vowed (1 Samuel 1:19–28).

CST: Answered prayer often requires releasing what we prayed for.

Can you trust God enough to give back the blessing He gave you—time, talent, or even a person?

Dessert – The Song of Victory, 1 Samuel 2:1–2 (WEB)

“Hannah prayed, and said, ‘My heart exults in Yahweh! My horn is exalted in Yahweh. My mouth is enlarged over my enemies, because I rejoice in your salvation. There is no one as holy as Yahweh, for there is no one besides you, nor is there any rock like our God.’”

Reflection:

True praise flows from answered pain. Hannah’s song came from a place of long weeping and finally, breakthrough.

What song has your victory written for you? (It could be an actual song, a testimony, or a phrase you hold onto.)

To-Go Box

Hannah’s story proves that barrenness—physical, emotional, or spiritual—is never the final word.

- Faith speaks life into empty places.
 - Honest prayers, poured out from a broken heart, reach God’s ears.
 - When God fills what was empty, the best response is to give the glory, and even the gift, back to Him.
-

Closing Prayer

“Lord, thank You for Hannah’s story and for reminding us that You hear the cries we pray in secret. Teach us to pour out our hearts honestly before You, to honor the vows we make, and to trust You with both our pain and our promises.

Where we feel barren or empty, speak life.

Where we have been misunderstood, let Your understanding surround us.

And when You answer, help us to give the glory—and even the blessing—back to You.

In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Activity – Word Scramble: Hannah’s Hope

Unscramble each word to reveal key truths from the lesson. (*Hints in parentheses*)

1. **NNAHHA** (her name) _____
2. **ULSAME** (the son she bore)

3. **ETARP** (what she did earnestly)

4. **THEFAI** (what God rewarded)

5. **LIHEFSI** (2 words, what she gave back to God)

Multiple Choice /Fill in the Blank

1. Elkanah was married to _____.
a. Hannah and Peninnah
b. Hannah and Phinehas
c. Hophni and Peninnah
d. None of the above
Answer.
2. Elkanah and his wives would go to sacrifice in _____ at the Lord of _____.
a. Judah, Heaven’s Armies
b. Judah, Heaven’s Angries
c. Shiloh, Heaven’s Armies
d. Shiloh, Heaven’s Angries
Answer.
3. A vow is a _____.
4. Hannah promised to never _____.
(a) Fight Peninnah
(b) Cut her child’s hair
(c) Lie again
(d) Come to the temple drunk
Answer.

5. “Seeing her lips _____ but hearing no _____, he thought she had been _____.”

(Check appendix for answers.)

Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study

BM2: Lesson 3 – Abram

No Heir, Wait Here

Theme: Trusting God when the wait is long

Background Text: Genesis 15:1–6; 16:1–5; 17:1–8

Key Verse: Genesis 15:6 (WEB)

“He believed in Yahweh, who credited it to him for righteousness.”

Appetizer – Faith Between Promises Genesis 15:1–3 (WEB)

¹ After these things Yahweh’s word came to Abram in a vision, saying, ‘Don’t be afraid, Abram. I am your shield, your exceedingly great reward.’ ² Abram said, ‘Lord Yahweh, what will you give me, since I go childless, and he who will inherit my estate is Eliezer of Damascus?’

³ Abram said, ‘Behold, to me you have given no children; and, behold, one born in my house is my heir.’

Many of us know what it feels like to sit between what God said and what we see. Abram had promises, but no child. Blessing was on his life, but barrenness was in his house.

CST: When promises linger, faith begins to question.

Abram didn’t pretend everything was fine—he told God honestly where his heart was: “What good are all these blessings if I don’t have the one thing You promised?”

Reflection:

What do *you* do when your vision from God hasn’t yet come to pass?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Promise Beyond Sight, Genesis 15:4–6 (WEB)

“Behold, Yahweh’s word came to him, saying, ‘This man will not be your heir, but he who will come out of your own body will be your heir.’ Yahweh brought him outside, and said, ‘Look now toward the sky, and count the stars, if you are able to count them.’ He said to Abram, ‘So shall your offspring be.’ He believed in Yahweh; and he reckoned it to him for righteousness.”

God did not deny Abram’s disappointment; He answered it with a bigger picture. God pulled Abram outside, pointed to the stars, and told him to count the uncountable.

CST: Faith is often proven in the unseen.

When sight fades, trust sharpens. God asked Abram to believe a promise that his eyes could not yet verify, and heaven called that belief “righteousness.”

Reflection:

What “stars” is God asking you to look at and believe for—even when your current situation says the opposite?

Bite 2 – Impatience in the Process, Genesis 16:1–4 (WEB)

¹ Now Sarai, Abram’s wife, bore him no children. She had a servant, an Egyptian, whose name was Hagar. ² Sarai said to Abram, ‘See now, Yahweh has restrained me from bearing. Please go in to my servant. It may be that I will obtain children by her.’ Abram listened to the voice of Sarai. ³ After Abram had lived ten years in the land of Canaan, Sarai took Hagar the Egyptian, her servant, and gave her to Abram her husband to be his wife. ⁴ He went to Hagar, and she conceived. When she saw that she had conceived, her mistress was despised in her eyes.

Sarai and Abram reached a breaking point in the waiting and decided to “help” God. Their plan produced a child—but also tension, comparison, and conflict. Waiting is not always easy but oftentimes required.

CST: Human shortcuts can complicate divine timing.

When we rush what God promised to perfect, we create situations He never asked us to manage. Grace can redeem our detours, but consequences are still real.

Reflection:

Where are you most tempted to “fix it yourself” instead of waiting on God’s way and God’s time?

Bite 3 – Promise Reaffirmed Genesis 17:1–5, 7 (WEB)

¹ When Abram was ninety-nine years old, Yahweh appeared to Abram and said to him, ‘I am God Almighty. Walk before me, and be blameless. ² I will make my covenant between me and you, and will multiply you exceedingly.’ ³ Abram fell on his face. God talked with him, saying, ⁴ ‘As for me, behold, my covenant is with you. You will be the father of a multitude of nations. ⁵ Your name will no longer be called Abram, but your name will be Abraham; for I have made you the father of a multitude of nations. ⁷ I will establish my covenant between me and you and your offspring after you throughout their generations for an everlasting covenant...’

God revisited Abram years later—not to cancel the promise, but to **expand** it and attach it to a covenant. He also changed Abram’s name to Abraham to match what heaven already saw.

CST: God’s promises come with identity shifts.

He renames us to remind us of who we are becoming, not what we’ve been. Abraham had to learn to answer to a name that sounded like the promise *before* the promise fully showed up.

Reflection:

Is there an area where God is calling you to think, speak, or walk according to His promise—before you see it?

Dessert – Faith Rewarded Through Time, Romans 4:20–21 (WEB)

“Yet, looking to the promise of God, he didn’t waver through unbelief, but grew strong through faith, giving glory to God, and being fully assured that what he had promised, he was also able to perform.”

Reflection:

God doesn't forget; He fulfills. Abraham's faith grew stronger over time, even while the promise seemed delayed.

How can you glorify God while you're still waiting for your "Isaac" to come forth?

To-Go Box

- Faith is not just belief—it's **endurance** through delay.
- Questioning God honestly doesn't disqualify you; staying stuck in unbelief does.
- Human shortcuts (like Hagar) may seem faster, but they complicate what God intended to be clean.
- When God reaffirms His promise, He often calls you by a new name or identity that lines up with your future.
- God's timeline is not denial; it's divine alignment.

Word Study

- **Abram** – "Exalted Father"
- **Abraham** – "Father of Many Nations"
- **El Shaddai** – "God Almighty," the all-sufficient One who sustains, provides, and fulfills His promises.

Closing Prayer

"God Almighty, El Shaddai, Thank You for being faithful even when my faith feels small. Teach me to wait on Your timing instead of forcing my own solutions. Help me to believe Your promises when I can't yet see the evidence.

Rename the places in my life that still sound like doubt and align my identity with what You have spoken. Make me fully assured that what You have promised, You are also able to perform. In Jesus' name, amen."

Activity – True or False: Trust the Timeline

1. Abram's faith never wavered from the start.
☐ True ☐ False
2. Sarai suggested a human solution to a divine promise.
☐ True ☐ False
3. God changed Abram's name after he demonstrated obedience.
☐ True ☐ False
4. Hagar's son was the covenant child.
☐ True ☐ False
5. God's timing tests faith before fulfilling it.
☐ True ☐ False

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Notes Section — Group Discussion & Personal Study

BM2 — Lesson 4: Chronic Conditions

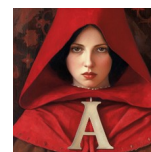
Victory Through the Blood

Theme: Faith That Heals

Background Text: Luke 8:42b–48

Key Verse: Luke 8:48 (WEB)

He said to her, ‘Daughter, cheer up. Your faith has made you well. Go in peace.’



Author’s Foreword (Intro/Reflection Setup)

“Unclean, Unclean, Unclean!”

In the Jewish law, as depicted in the Pentateuch, many illnesses and conditions could make a person “unclean.” Those labeled unclean could not enter the temple, attend gatherings, or move freely in the community. Some were restricted to their homes or pushed outside normal society. They had to *announce* their condition whenever they came near people.

Imagine living in a world where you had to brandish your “dirty secret” like the old Scarlet Letter—exposed, ashamed, and isolated.

Now imagine carrying that weight not for a few days, but for **twelve years**.

Appetizer – The Unclean Made Whole, Luke 8:42b–43a (WEB)

“...as he went, the multitudes pressed against him. A woman who had a flow of blood for twelve years...”

She had spent everything she had on physicians. No one could help her. Her body was weak, her money was gone, and her hope was hanging by a thread.

You’ve tried every YouTube remedy, every social media hack, every doctor, every urgent care, every “miracle” treatment and payment plan... and still no solution. Your resources are drained, and the situation hasn’t changed. That was the woman’s reality.

CST

Imagine having a condition that silently drains you from the inside for over a decade. No clear answers. No lasting relief. Just ongoing pain, shame, and exhaustion.

Reflection:

Have you ever been in a season where you tried *everything* but still had to rely on faith for breakthrough?

Main Course – Faith That Reaches Out

Bite 1 – A Desperate Touch, Luke 8:43b–44 (WEB)

“...who had spent all her living on physicians and could not be healed by any, came behind him and touched the fringe of his cloak. Immediately the flow of her blood stopped.”

She didn’t ask for the microphone, or a front-row seat, or a special audience. She just wanted to get close enough to **touch** Jesus—close enough to reach for the One everyone else was only crowding around.

CST:

It takes courage to reach out when the crowd feels overwhelming. She didn’t need to be seen by people; she needed to be **healed** by Jesus.

Question:

How hard would it be to get close enough to touch a world leader or celebrity? Yet this woman pushed through every barrier—cultural, physical, emotional—to reach the King of kings.

Reflection:

Where in your life do you need that same “pressing through” kind of faith?

Bite 2 – Faith Recognized, Luke 8:45–47 (WEB)

⁴⁵ Jesus said, ‘Who touched me?’ When all denied it, Peter and those with him said, ‘Master, the multitudes press and jostle you, and you say, ‘Who touched me?’ ’ ⁴⁶ But Jesus said, ‘Someone did touch me, for I perceived that power has gone out of me.’ ⁴⁷ When the woman saw that she was not hidden, she came trembling, and falling down before him declared to him in the presence of all the people the reason why she had touched him, and how she was healed immediately.”

The crowd was pressing against Jesus, but **only one touch drew power**. Proximity is not the same as faith. Many bumped into Him, but only one believed *Him* for change for the issue that ailed her life.

CST:

Jesus felt the pull of faith. Power responded not to casual contact but to intentional belief. When the Holy Spirit meets genuine faith, something always shifts.

Reflection:

Recall a time when you had to “touch heaven”—a situation that drove you to seek God’s power above all else. What was happening, and how did that season change you?

Bite 3 – Faith Rewarded, Luke 8:48 (WEB)

“He said to her, ‘Daughter, cheer up. Your faith has made you well. Go in peace.’”

One sentence changed everything—her health, her status, and her identity. She was no longer “unclean woman”; she was **Daughter**.

Author’s Commentary

Her long struggle ended with a single word of affirmation from Jesus. When He calls you Daughter

or Son, He doesn't just fix your issue—He restores your place in the family. The Woman with the Issue of Blood is a story that many can relate to you having a problem and unfortunately making God or prayer your “last resort”, it's like the dreaded red button under the glass that you do NOT want to push! Push - Pray Until Something Happens - let your faith connect with the Word and power of God. Nobody is saying don't go to the doctor, but the message is bring your faith to the doctor's office and bring your ISSUES to the altar.

So many of us have suffered in things for a long while, and Jesus is waiting on us to do our part and trust him with it. Break through the doubt, press through the challenges and arrive at the hem of God and the spiritual connection to the healing that was released when our Savior was tied and hung on a tree. Through an long term unclean messed up, messy situation - though her blood was filthy his Blood is cleansing and through it there is victory to everyone who is willing to accept all the benefits of being redeemed, hallelujah!

Dessert – Push Through the Crowd

Sometimes our faith becomes the “last resort,” but God invites us to make it our **first response**. The woman could have stayed home, stayed hidden, stayed hopeless—but she chose to move.

Like her, we are called to:

- Push through doubt.
- Push through fear.
- Push through shame.
- Push through the noise of the crowd...

...until we reach the hem of His garment.

Reflection:

What crowd—voices, opinions, fears, distractions—do you need to push through right now to get closer to Jesus?

To-Go Box

Her blood made her unclean.

His blood made her whole.

Through Christ's sacrifice:

- We are redeemed, not rejected.
- We are restored, not ruined.
- We are cleansed, not canceled.
- No matter how long the struggle has lasted, **victory is still possible through His blood.**

Carry this with you:

When you reach for Jesus in faith, He always has more healing than you have hurt.

Prayer

“Lord Jesus, Thank You that Your blood still heals, restores, and makes us whole. Thank You for seeing us when we feel unseen, and for calling us ‘Daughter’ and ‘Son’ when the world calls us ‘unclean.’

Give us the courage to press through every crowd of fear, shame, or doubt to reach You. Teach us to make faith our first response, not our last resort. Where we are bleeding in our bodies, minds, or hearts, let Your healing power flow.

Fill us with Your peace as we walk forward in faith.

In Your mighty name, amen.”

Notes Section — Group Discussion & Personal Study

Activity – Word Search Puzzle

Find each word from the Word Bank in the puzzle. Words may be hidden forwards, backwards, up, down, or diagonally.

T	A	B	U	D	K	B
B	W	T	N	K	J	R
I	I	E	C	Q	K	O
L	A	M	L	A	N	D
H	E	I	E	V	E	E
C	I	M	A	I	E	N
E	D	W	N	W	S	A
C	R	O	W	D	I	C
R	E	H	T	A	R	T
R	M	O	W	D	A	M
T	D	E	E	S	O	R
R	O	D	H	R	A	G
S	F	E	H	T	E	R
H	A	N	L	O	V	E
L	I	E	R	S	A	W
Y	T	M	A	H	N	O
T	H	N	O	H	T	P
P	A	L	I	E	V	T

WORD BANK: UNCLEAN, FAITH, HEM, POWER, HEAL, KNEES, CROWD, TWELVE, LOVE

Appendix – Breakfast Month 2 (AE) Answer Key

Theme: The Art of Through – Youth Edition

Lesson 1 – Joseph: The Young Dreamer

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Joseph's brothers sold him for _____ pieces of silver.
2. Joseph resisted the temptation of _____.
3. Pharaoh said Joseph was filled with the _____ of God.
4. Joseph's brothers bowed before him in _____.

Answer Key:

1. **Twenty (20)**
 2. **Potiphar's wife**
 3. The **Spirit** of God
 4. **Egypt**
-

Lesson 2 – Hannah: Barren but Not Lifeless

Activity – Word Scramble: Hannah's Hope

1. NNAHHA → **HANNAH**
2. ULSAME → **SAMUEL**
3. YERARP → **PRAYER**
4. THFAI → **FAITH**
5. LIHEFSI → **HIS LIFE**

Fill in the Blank / Multiple Choice

1. Elkanah was married to _____.

- Correct answer: **a. Hannah and Peninnah**
 - 2. Elkanah and his wives would go to sacrifice in _____ at the Lord of _____.
 - Correct answer: **c. Shiloh, Heaven's Armies**
 - 3. A vow is a _____.
 - Suggested key: **a serious promise or commitment made before God.**
 - 4. Hannah promised to never _____.
 - Correct answer: **(b) Cut her child's hair** (reflecting the Nazirite-like vow regarding Samuel).
 - 5. "Seeing her lips _____ but hearing no _____, he thought she had been _____."
 - Correct answer: **moving, sound, drinking**
-

Lesson 3 – Abram: No Heir, Wait Here

Activity – True or False: Trust the Timeline

1. Abram's faith never wavered from the start.
2. Sarai suggested a human solution to a divine promise.
3. God changed Abram's name after he demonstrated obedience.
4. Hagar's son was the covenant child.
5. God's timing tests faith before fulfilling it.

Answer Key:

1. **False** – He wrestled and questioned, even while believing.
2. **True** – Sarai proposed using Hagar to "help" fulfill the promise.
3. **True** – The name change comes as part of covenant confirmation after years of following.
4. **False** – Isaac, not Ishmael, was the covenant child.
5. **True** – Waiting often sharpens and proves our faith.

Lesson 4 – Victory Through the Blood

Activity – Crossword Puzzle

Letters that form the hidden words are **bolded** for easy reference.

T	A	B	U	D	K	B
B	W	T	N	K	J	R
I	I	E	C	Q	K	O
L	A	M	L	A	N	D
H	E	I	E	V	E	E
C	I	M	A	I	E	N
E	D	W	N	W	S	A
C	R	O	W	D	I	C
R	E	H	T	A	R	T
R	M	O	W	D	A	M
T	D	E	E	S	O	R
R	O	D	H	R	A	G
S	F	E	H	T	E	R
H	A	N	L	O	V	E
L	I	E	R	S	A	W
Y	T	M	A	H	N	O
T	H	N	O	H	T	P
P	A	L	I	E	V	T

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES

Break • fast - Month 3

Adult Edition

Theme:

Faith & Foresight

“In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God.”

— Philippians 4:6 (WEB)

Introduction - *Faith & Foresight*

Faith and foresight are meant to walk hand-in-hand in our journey with God. Faith helps us trust what we cannot yet see, and foresight helps us prepare for what God has promised—even before He shows us all the details. Together, they invite us to follow God’s lead when the road ahead still looks uncertain.

Hebrews 11:1 tells us, “Now faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do not see.” Faith lifts our eyes past the present moment and anchors our hearts in God’s truth instead of our changing circumstances. Foresight—spiritual insight shaped by God’s perspective—then guides the decisions we make today so they line up with what God is doing tomorrow.

Scripture gives us clear examples of people who lived with both faith and foresight. Noah built the ark long before the first raindrop fell (Genesis 6). Abraham obeyed God’s call and left home without knowing his destination (Hebrews 11:8). Joseph stored grain during years of abundance because he trusted God’s warning about the famine ahead (Genesis 41). Their lives show a consistent pattern: faith listens to God, and foresight gets ready for His plan.

In this study, we’ll see that walking with God takes more than belief—it takes vision grounded in faith. As we grow in spiritual foresight, we stop merely reacting to what’s happening around us and start responding to what God has spoken within us. Faith gives us the boldness to move forward; foresight helps us move with wisdom and purpose.

Breakfast Edition Month 3 - Lesson 1: Rahab

Faith That Took Action

Theme: Courage in the Face of Danger

Background Text: Joshua 2:1–21; 6:22–25

Key Verse: Hebrews 11:31 (WEB)

“By faith, Rahab the prostitute didn’t perish with those who were disobedient, having received the spies in peace.”

Faith that acts before the promise is visible.

Appetizer – The Risk That Redefined a Life, Joshua 2:1, 3–4 (WEB)

“Joshua the son of Nun secretly sent two men out of Shittim as spies, saying, ‘Go, view the land, including Jericho.’ They went and came into the house of a prostitute whose name was Rahab, and slept there.”

“Jericho’s king sent to Rahab, saying, ‘Bring out the men who have come to you, who have entered into your house; for they have come to spy out all the land.’ The woman took the two men, and hid them...”

CST

Rahab’s name shows up differently in Scripture—*Rachab* in Matthew’s genealogy of Christ and *Rahab* in the Book of Joshua—but her faith stayed the same. She wasn’t born an Israelite, yet her belief in Israel’s God was strong enough to override her fear of the king.

Faith acted **before** the promise was visible. She chose courage in the face of death.

Reflection Question

Has your faith ever been tested in a way that demanded courage before you saw the results?

Main Course

Bite 1 – A Faith Born from Hearing, Joshua 2:8–9,11 (WEB)

⁸ Before they had lain down, she came up to them on the roof. ⁹ She said to the men, “I know that Yahweh has given you the land, and that the fear of you has fallen upon us, and that all the inhabitants of the land melt away before you. ¹¹ As soon as we had heard it, our hearts melted, and there wasn’t any more spirit in any man, because of you: for Yahweh your God, he is God in heaven above, and on earth beneath.

CST

Faith comes by *hearing*—and Rahab proves it. She believed without ever seeing the Red Sea part or the Amorite kings fall. Testimonies of God’s power traveled farther than Israel’s feet, and those stories were enough to birth faith in her heart.

Her belief in a God she had never met was strong enough to inspire obedience in danger.

Reflection Questions

- What promises has God made to you that are not yet fulfilled? What action might He be waiting on from you?
-
-
-

Bite 2 – When Faith Meets Action, Joshua 2:12–13, 18 (WEB)

¹² Now therefore, please swear to me by Yahweh, since I have dealt kindly with you, that you also will deal kindly with my father’s house, and give me a true sign; ¹³ and that you will save alive my father, my mother, my brothers, and my sisters, and all that they have, and will deliver our lives from death.”

¹⁸ Behold, when we come into the land, tie this line of scarlet thread in the window which you used to let us down. Gather to yourself into the house your father, your mother, your brothers, and all your father’s household.

CST

The scarlet rope became a visible sign of an invisible covenant. It wasn’t just a safety signal—it was a prophetic symbol of redemption. Her faith wasn’t passive; it was tied to **obedience**.

Her decision to hang that rope out the window saved not just her life, but her entire household.

Reflection Question

What “scarlet rope” of obedience have you hung out as proof of your trust in God?

Bite 3 – Faith That Rewrites the Future (Joshua 6:22–23, 25, WEB)

“Joshua said to the two men who had spied out the land, ‘Go into the prostitute’s house, and bring the woman and all that she has out from there, as you swore to her.’”

“The young men who were spies went in, and brought out Rahab, with her father, her mother, her brothers, and all that she had... But Rahab the prostitute, her father’s household, and all that she had, Joshua saved alive. She lives in the middle of Israel to this day, because she hid the messengers whom Joshua sent to spy out Jericho.”

CST

Faith not only *saves*—it *transforms*. Rahab went from outcast to insider, from pagan prostitute to part of God’s covenant people, and eventually into the family line of the Messiah Himself. Sometimes, the least likely person carries the greatest impact.

Reflection Question

Who might be saved, inspired, or transformed by **your** act of faith today?

Dessert – Faith Remembered, Hebrews 11:31 (WEB)

“By faith, Rahab the prostitute, didn’t perish with those who were disobedient, having received the spies in peace.”

Reflection

God didn’t highlight Rahab’s past to shame her but to magnify His grace. Her label didn’t stop her legacy. Faith rewrote her ending—and it can rewrite yours too.

Write one sentence of gratitude to God for giving you a future that’s bigger than your past:

To-Go Box

- Faith hears what God has done and believes what He *will* do.
- Rahab's courage shows that obedience in a single moment can shift an entire family's destiny.
- Your history does not disqualify you; your response to God's invitation defines you.

Carry this truth:

Faith acts first; foresight trusts God with the outcome.

Don't let fear of judgment, failure, or your past silence your obedience. Like Rahab, your courage today can redeem generations tomorrow.

Word Study

- **Rahab / Rachab (Hebrew: רחב)** – “Spacious, broad.” Symbolic of enlargement and room made through faith.
 - **Scarlet Rope** – A sign of covenant and protection, echoing the Passover blood on the doorposts and pointing forward to the blood of Christ.
 - **Foresight** – Spiritual anticipation rooted in trust that God is already working beyond what we see.
-

Activity – True or False: Rahab's Faith

1. Rahab was born an Israelite woman. ☐
 2. The scarlet rope represented obedience and covenant. ☐
 3. Rahab acted only out of fear, not faith. ☐
 4. Rahab's faith saved her entire family. ☐
 5. Rahab later appeared in Jesus' family line. ☐
(Check answers in the Appendix)
-

Author's Testimony

I once faced my own test of faith. I needed funds to remodel a home for veterans in need. Quotes came in as high as \$30,000, and my account was empty. But I prayed, “Lord, You know my needs,

Jehovah-Jireh, my provider.” Within a week, God sent two unexpected renters who paid exactly \$12,000—the remaining amount I needed to complete the work.

Faith made a way I could not see. Like Rahab, I learned that obedience, no matter how small, can open doors for God’s miraculous provision. *Father, help each reader to boldly break away from things that are holding them back and embrace the opportunities to grow in your and walk into their purpose, in Jesus name amen.*

Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study

BM3 — Lesson 2: Abigail

Wisdom on the Move

Background Text: 1 Samuel 25:2–39; Proverbs 15:1 (WEB)

Key Verse: Proverbs 15:1

“A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger.”

Wisdom in motion: faith that chooses peace over pride.

Appetizer – The Courage to Step In, 1 Samuel 25:18–20 (WEB)

“Then Abigail hurried and took two hundred loaves of bread, two containers of wine, five sheep ready dressed, five seahs of parched grain, one hundred clusters of raisins, and two hundred cakes of figs, and laid them on donkeys. She said to her young men, ‘Go on before me. Behold, I come after you.’ But she didn’t tell her husband, Nabal.

It was so, as she rode on her donkey, and came down by the covert of the mountain, that behold, David and his men came down toward her; and she met them.”

Abigail wasted no time. She quickly gathered two hundred loaves of bread, two containers of wine, five prepared sheep, roasted grain, clusters of raisins, and cakes of figs. She packed them on donkeys and said to her servants, “Go on ahead. I will follow you shortly.” But she didn’t tell her husband Nabal what she was doing. Sometimes moving strategically is moving stealthily!

CST

Abigail didn’t wait for permission to do what was right. She used foresight—seeing danger ahead and acting to prevent disaster. Her faith wasn’t just belief; it was movement toward peace.

Reflection Question

When was the last time you acted on faith to prevent harm or conflict?

Main Course

Bite 1 – The Folly of Nabal, 1 Samuel 25:10–11, 14–17 (WEB)

“Nabal answered David’s servants, and said, ‘Who is David? Who is the son of Jesse? There are many servants who break away from their masters these days. Shall I then take my bread, my water, and my meat that I have killed for my shearers, and give it to men who I don’t know where they come from?’”

Later, one of Nabal’s servants told Abigail how David’s men had been good to them in the fields, how they had not been harmed or stolen from, and yet Nabal “rushed on them” with insults. He warned her that disaster was hanging over the household because Nabal was such a worthless man “that one can’t speak to him”

CST

Nabal’s arrogance created a crisis. Foolish pride will always test someone’s faith. Abigail’s faith met that test with wisdom, not words of war. The bible says in James 1:19-20 (KJV, paraphrased), that we should be ‘quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to wrath. Because the wrath of man doesn’t produce the righteousness of God. Nabal wasn’t trying to hear anyone of reason and sometimes we hear through emotional filters, and it is important for us to identify and call out these barriers to the truth, just like Nabal’s servants did to Abigail.

Reflection Question

Have you ever had to respond to someone’s anger or disrespect with peace instead of pride?

Bite 2 – Faith in Action, 1 Samuel 25:23–31 (WEB)

“When Abigail saw David, she hurried, and alighted from her donkey, and fell before David on her face, and bowed herself to the ground. She fell at his feet, and said, ‘On me, my lord, on me be the iniquity; and please let your handmaid speak in your ears. Hear the words of your handmaid. Please don’t let my lord pay attention to this worthless fellow, Nabal; for as his name is, so is he. Nabal is his name, and folly is with him...’”

When Abigail saw David, she quickly got off her donkey and bowed low before him. She fell at his feet and said, “I accept all blame in this matter, my lord. Please listen to what I have to say... When the Lord has done all He promised and has made you leader of Israel, don’t let this be a blemish on your record.”

She strategically pointed David back to God’s promise over his life—that Yahweh would surely make him ruler over Israel. She urged him not to carry needless bloodshed or vengeance on his record when that day came.

CST

Abigail took on the blame for her husband’s offense—an act of courage and foresight. She spoke life into David’s calling instead of fueling his wrath. Her humility redirected the entire situation.

Reflection Questions

- What does it mean to “stand in the gap” for someone else’s mistake?

- Have you ever had to de-escalate a situation you didn’t cause?

- Did your response bring God honor or dishonor?

Bite 3 – A Wise Outcome, 1 Samuel 25:32–35 (WEB)

“David said to Abigail, ‘Blessed is Yahweh, the God of Israel, who sent you today to meet me! Blessed is your discretion, and blessed are you, who have kept me today from blood guiltiness, and from avenging myself with my own hand.... I have listened to your voice, and have accepted your person.’ So David received from her hand that which she had brought him. Then he said to her, ‘Go up in peace to your house. Behold, I have listened to your voice, and have granted your request.’”

David replied to Abigail, “Praise the Lord, the God of Israel, who has sent you to meet me today! Thank God for your good sense! David is a sensible guy. The same one that stood up for the people of God and Bless you for keeping me from murder and from carrying out vengeance with my own hands.” Then David accepted her gifts and told her, “Return home in peace. I have heard what you said. We will not kill your husband.” If he didn’t kill Saul, David was truly after peace and support for the men who supported others- nothing more.

CST

One act of wisdom can save an entire household. Faith foresaw danger; wisdom found peace. Abigail's actions honored God, David, and her own integrity.

Reflection Question

What would the world look like if more of us prayed for wisdom before reacting?

Dessert – The Aftermath of Obedience (1 Samuel 25:38–39, WEB)

“About ten days later, Yahweh struck Nabal, so that he died. When David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, ‘Blessed be Yahweh, who has pleaded the cause of my reproach from the hand of Nabal, and has kept back his servant from evil.’”

About ten days later, the Lord struck Nabal, and he died. When David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, “Praise the Lord, who has avenged the insult I received from Nabal and has kept me from doing it myself.” Then David sent messengers to propose marriage to Abigail.

CST

When God vindicates, He also elevates. Abigail's humility brought her favor—she went from the wife of a fool to the bride of a future king.

To-Go Box

- Faith and foresight are more than belief—they are wisdom in motion.
 - Pride creates unnecessary battles; humility opens unexpected doors.
 - When we humble ourselves and act with discernment, God can turn conflict into protection and even promotion.
-

Closing Prayer (Abigail – Wisdom on the Move)

“Lord, thank You for Abigail’s example of wisdom and courage. Help me respond with grace when other people’s foolishness creates messes around me. Teach me to honor You, treat Your people well, and trust You to handle what I can’t. In Jesus’ name, amen.

Word Study

- **Abigail (Hebrew: אביגיל – “Avigayil”)** — “My father’s joy” or “source of joy.” Her character embodied the beauty of her name; she became a channel of peace and joy even in chaos.
- **Nabal (Hebrew: נבל – “Nabal”)** — “Foolish” or “senseless.” His actions reflected his name, showing how arrogance blinds us to wisdom and leads to destruction.
- **Scapegoat (Hebrew: עזאזל – “Azazel”)** — From Leviticus 16, referring to the goat released into the wilderness carrying the sins of the people. Symbolically, Abigail bore the “guilt” of her household to intercede for peace.
- **Foresight** — Spiritual sensitivity that anticipates and prepares for what God is revealing ahead of time.

Write one line about where you need *foresight* right now:

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Abigail acted with _____ and faith, not fear.
2. Nabal's pride led to his _____.
3. David praised God for Abigail's _____.
4. Abigail's wisdom prevented _____ and brought peace.

(Check answers in the Appendix)

Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study

BM3 — Lesson 3: The Centurion

Faith That Commands Results

Theme: Trusting Jesus' Word

Background Text: Matthew 8:5–13; Luke 7:1–10

Key Verse: Matthew 8:10 (WEB)

“When Jesus heard it, he marveled, and said... ‘Most certainly I tell you, I haven’t found so great a faith, not even in Israel.’”

Faith that trusts the Word, not the circumstances.

Appetizer – The Power of a Word, Matthew 8:5–8 (WEB)

⁵ When he came into Capernaum, a centurion came to him, asking him for help,
⁶ saying, “Lord, my servant lies in the house paralyzed, grievously tormented.” ⁷ Jesus said to him, “I will come and heal him.”

The centurion answered, ‘Lord, I’m not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed.’

The centurion didn’t ask Jesus for a visit—he asked Him for a word. He believed that one word from Jesus could travel farther and work faster than any doctor, medicine, or ritual.

CST Thought

Faith is not about proximity—it’s about posture. The centurion knew Jesus didn’t have to be physically present to be powerfully effective. True belief doesn’t demand evidence; it simply trusts the Word.

Reflection Question

Have you ever believed God for something without needing to “see” how He would do it?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Humility Before Honor, Luke 7:1–4, 6–7 (WEB)

⁷ After he had finished speaking in the hearing of the people, he entered into Capernaum. ² A certain centurion’s servant, who was dear to him, was sick and at the point of death. ³ When he heard about Jesus, he sent to him elders of the Jews, asking him to come and save his servant. ⁴ When they came to Jesus, they begged him earnestly, saying, “He is worthy for you to do this for him, synagogue for us.”

Jesus went with them. When he was now not far from the house, the centurion sent friends to him, saying to him, ‘Lord, don’t trouble yourself, for I am not worthy for you to come under my roof. Therefore I didn’t even think myself worthy to come to you; but say the word, and my servant will be healed.’”

The Jewish elders said, “He is worthy.” The centurion said, “I am not.” The people pointed to his résumé; he pointed to Jesus’ authority. God in the flesh, (Jesus) was moved by his heart and his application of faith.

CST Thought

Humility is the bridge to divine help. The centurion had status, money, and influence—but he laid all of that down at Jesus’ feet. Faith is strongest when pride is silent.

Reflection Question

How does humility open the door for faith to operate in your life?

Bite 2 – The Understanding of Authority, Matthew 8:9 (WEB)

“For I am also a man under authority, having soldiers under me. I tell this one, ‘Go,’ and he goes; and another, ‘Come,’ and he comes; and to my servant, ‘Do this,’ and he does it.”

The centurion lived his life in chains of command—he understood how orders flowed from a higher rank to those beneath. When he looked at Jesus, he recognized heavenly authority at work: the same power that governs sickness, distance, and timing.

CST Thought

The centurion understood authority not just as control, but as covering. He believed that if Jesus spoke, creation itself had to respond. He saw that Jesus carried a higher command than Rome—kingdom authority.

Reflection Question

When you pray, do you believe the words you speak *in Jesus’ name* carry that same delegated authority?

Bite 3 – Faith That Amazed Jesus, Luke 7:9–10; Matthew 8:13 (WEB)

“When Jesus heard these things, he marveled at him, and turned and said to the multitude who followed him, ‘I tell you, I have not found such great faith, no, not in Israel!’ Those who were sent, returning to the house, found that the servant who had been sick was well.”

“Jesus said to the centurion, ‘Go your way. As you have believed, so let it be done for you.’ His servant was healed in that hour.”

A Roman soldier’s faith made Jesus marvel. No ritual, no long speech, no physical touch—just a request based on understanding who Jesus is and what His Word can do.

CST Thought

Faith works across every barrier—distance, language, culture, status, or time. The Word still heals, restores, and delivers when we believe it and speak it. Let us begin to lean in, unlocking and release the depth and the height of God’s love expressed towards us, the bible says that he doesn’t want his people to be lost but to come to the knowledge of the truth. (2 Peter 3:9)

Reflection Question

Where in your life do you need to trust that God's Word is already at work, even when you can't see the process?

Dessert – Believing Without Seeing

The centurion never demanded, "Show me how." He simply said, "Just say the word." His servant was healed without Jesus ever stepping into the house.

Reflection

What would shift in your prayer life if you trusted what God said more than what you see?

To-Go Box

- Faith and foresight together teach us that authority in prayer isn't about volume or visibility—it's about confidence in the Word of God.
- Humility positions us to receive what pride would block.
- Real faith does not require God to "prove it" first; it rests in what He has already spoken.
- When you recognize Jesus' authority, you can walk in your own God-given authority with boldness and peace.

Closing Prayer

"Lord Jesus, thank You for the centurion's example of simple, strong faith. Help me to trust Your Word more than what I see and to pray with confidence in Your authority, not my own strength. Teach me to stay humble, to believe that when You speak, things change. In Your name, amen."

Personal Prayer Space

Write your own reflection or prayer to God about trusting His Word and His authority in your life:

Word Study

- **Centurion (Latin: *Centurio*)** – A Roman officer over about one hundred soldiers; represents leadership through discipline, obedience, and order.
- **Authority (Greek: *Exousia*, ἐξουσία)** – Permission and delegated power; the right to act. Jesus carries authority over nature, sickness, sin, and even death.
- **Faith (Greek: *Pistis*, πίστις)** – Trust, conviction, and complete reliance upon God’s truth and character.

Write a short line about where you need to trust Jesus’ authority more fully:

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. The centurion’s faith worked even at a _____.
2. Jesus said, “I have not found anyone in Israel with such great _____.”
3. True faith doesn’t need evidence; it trusts the _____.
4. The centurion understood the power of _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

BM3 — Lesson 4: Joseph of Arimathea

Trust the Process

Theme: Obedience in the Quiet Moments

Background Text : Matthew 27:57–61; John 19:38–42

Key Verse: John 19:38 (WEB)

“After these things, Joseph of Arimathea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus’ body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body.”

Faith that honors Jesus even when the story looks finished.

Appetizer – Faith in Action, Matthew 27:57–58 (WEB)

“When evening had come, there came a rich man from Arimathea named Joseph, who himself was also Jesus’ disciple. This man went to Pilate, and asked for Jesus’ body. Then Pilate commanded the body to be given up.”

Joseph of Arimathea was a rich man, a respected council member, and a quiet follower of Jesus. When many had run away in fear, he stepped forward in love and courage. He went straight to Pilate and asked for the body of the crucified Christ—a bold, risky request that publicly tied his name to Jesus at the very moment things looked the worst.

CST Thought

Even in loss, faith moves us to act in honor. Joseph’s decision to claim Jesus’ body was not loud or flashy, but it was a quiet and powerful display of devotion when many others had fled.

Reflection Question

When have you had to act on your faith quietly but boldly, even when others were afraid to stand?

Main Course – The Pivot

Bite 1 Provision in Place, Matthew 27:59–60 (WEB)

“Joseph took the body, and wrapped it in a clean linen cloth, and laid it in his own new tomb, which he had cut out in the rock. Then he rolled a great stone to the door of the tomb, and departed.”

Joseph used what he had already prepared for himself—a new tomb carved in the rock—to honor Jesus. He wrapped the Lord’s body carefully, placed Him in that tomb, and sealed it with a great stone. What Joseph once thought was for his future became part of God’s bigger plan.

CST Thought

God’s provision is never late. Long before Jesus’ crucifixion, the Father had already chosen and prepared Joseph to meet this moment. What looked like a personal investment (a private tomb) became a kingdom assignment.

Author’s Commentary

It wasn’t just a believer who requested the body of Jesus, but Joseph of Arimathea—a wealthy man and quiet follower of Christ. He didn’t realize that the tomb he built for himself would one day hold the body of the Savior of the world. His influence and position on the council gave him access to Pilate, and because of that, the king granted his request for the body. God had already provided everything needed from Christ’s birth to His burial. All we must do is trust the process.

Sometimes the Lord will place you in a role, job, or position you don’t fully understand—not for your comfort, but for His assignment.

Reflection Question

Is there something God has called you to do that you don't yet understand? Are you willing to trust the process while your faith grows?

Bite 2 – Courage to Be Counted, John 19:38–40 (WEB)

“After these things, Joseph of Arimathaea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus' body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body. Nicodemus, who at first came to Jesus by night, also came bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about a hundred Roman pounds. So they took Jesus' body, and bound it in linen cloths with the spices, as the custom of the Jews is to bury.”

Joseph had been a *secret* disciple, afraid of what the Jewish leaders might say. But at the cross, his secret faith became public action. Nicodemus, who once came to Jesus at night, joined him in this bold, costly act of honor. Both men stepped out of the shadows to align themselves with a “condemned” Messiah.

CST Thought

There comes a time when quiet belief must become visible obedience. Faith that stays hidden forever never fully walks in purpose. Joseph and Nicodemus show us that even if you started secretly, God can still call you to stand boldly.

Reflection Question

Where is God asking you to move from silent agreement to visible obedience?

Dessert – Faith Sealed in Stone, John 19:40–42 (WEB)

“So they took Jesus' body, and bound it in linen cloths with the spices, as the custom of the Jews is to bury. Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden. In the garden

was a new tomb in which no man had ever yet been laid. 'Then because of the Jews' Preparation Day (for the tomb was near at hand) they laid Jesus there.'"

Everything about this scene looked final: the spices, the linen, the new tomb, the stone. Yet heaven knew this was not the end—it was a setup. The garden tomb was not a permanent resting place; it was the stage for resurrection.

CST Thought

When you trust God's process, even what looks like a burial can become the birthplace of breakthrough. What we call "the end" may be where God is just getting started.

Reflection Question

What area of your life feels "sealed in stone" right now—and how might God be working behind the scenes in ways you cannot see yet?

To-Go Box

- Faith and foresight remind us that obedience opens doors long before we know we'll need to walk through them.
- God often uses our resources, positions, and plans for purposes bigger than we imagined.
- Trust that God's plans are already in motion—even when you can't see the full picture yet.
- Like Joseph of Arimathea, your quiet preparation today may be part of a major move of God tomorrow.

Closing Prayer

"Lord, thank You for Joseph of Arimathea's example of quiet, courageous faith. Help me to trust Your process, even when I don't understand every step. Use what I have and where I am for Your purpose, not just my plans. In Jesus' name, amen."

Personal Prayer Space

Write your own reflection or prayer to God about trusting His timing and His process in your life:

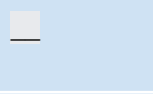
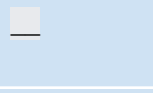
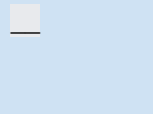
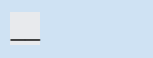
Word Study

- **Arimathea** – A town near Jerusalem; the name is associated with “heights” or a high place.
- **Joseph (Hebrew: *Yosef*)** – “He will add” or “He increases” — prophetic of increase and multiplication.
- **Trust (Hebrew: *Batach*)** – To rely on, be confident, or secure; a firm confidence in God’s provision and timing.

Write a short line about where you need to *batach*—to lean hard into trusting God’s process:

Activity – Connect the Process

Match each act of faith (left) with the result (right).

Match		Activity		Phrase
	1	Joseph's request for Jesus' body	A	The burial fulfilled prophecy with reverence.
	2	Wrapping Jesus in linen	B	A temporary seal that set up resurrection
	3	Building his own tomb	C	Jesus' body was placed in a tomb of honor.
	4	Rolling the stone	D	God used a personal plan for divine purpose

Reflection Thought (Activity Tie-In)

Faith builds what it may not yet understand, trusting that God will reveal its purpose in due time. Write a declaration that stretches your faith but is something you need/want/or hope the Lord will favor you to that end.

Appendix – Breakfast Month 3 (AE) Answer Key

Theme: Faith & Foresight – Youth Edition

Lesson 1 – Rahab: Faith That Took Action

Activity – True or False: Rahab's Faith

Lesson 1 – Rahab: Faith That Took Action

Activity – True or False

1. Rahab was an Israelite woman raised in a godly home.
➤ False – She was a Canaanite woman from Jericho.
 2. The scarlet rope was a sign of the agreement between Rahab and the spies.
➤ True
 3. Rahab's actions showed both faith in God and concern for her family.
➤ True
 4. Rahab's faith only affected her, not anyone else.
➤ False – Her whole household was saved.
 5. Rahab is later mentioned in the family line of Jesus.
➤ True – She appears in His genealogy.
-

Lesson 2 – Abigail: Wisdom on the Move

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Abigail acted with wisdom and faith, not fear.
 2. Nabal's pride led to his death.
 3. David praised God for Abigail's good sense/wisdom.
 4. Abigail's wisdom prevented bloodshed/killing and brought peace.
-

Lesson 3 – The Centurion: Faith That Commands Results

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. The centurion's faith worked even at a distance.
 2. Jesus said, "I have not found anyone in Israel with such great faith."
 3. True faith doesn't need evidence; it trusts the Word.
 4. The centurion understood the power of authority.
-

Lesson 4 – Joseph of Arimathea: Trust the Process

Activity – Connect the Process

Match each act of faith with the correct result:

- 1 Joseph's request for Jesus' body → **Jesus' body was placed in a tomb of honor.**
- 2 Building his own tomb → **God used a personal plan for divine purpose.**
- 3 Wrapping Jesus in linen → **The burial fulfilled prophecy with reverence.**
- 4 Rolling the stone → **A temporary seal that set up resurrection power.**

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